

Assignment Rubric

UJT 1333 Advances in Technology and Management Research · Week 12: Technology Strategy and R&D Management · Individual assignment

1. Assignment

Title: Corporate In-house Startup Programs: A Management Assessment

Task: Examine corporate in-house startup programs (including internal venturing and corporate venturing schemes) from the perspective of corporate management, and assess their merits and demerits. Your paper must:

- (1) position the program within technology strategy and the technology acquisition approaches (in-house R&D, alliances, industry–government–academia collaboration, venture collaboration);
- (2) analyse the managerial merits and demerits from multiple perspectives, supported by literature or cases; and
- (3) derive recommendations for a company that introduces or operates such a program.

Requirements: 1,200–1,500 words in English (excluding references); at least five peer-reviewed sources or credible cases, cited in APA 7th edition style; structure: Introduction / Positioning / Analysis of merits and demerits / Recommendations / Conclusion / References; submit as a single PDF.

2. Rubric (3 learning objectives × 3 levels)

Learning objective	Weight	Level 3 — Excellent	Level 2 — Satisfactory	Level 1 — Developing
LO1 Positioning Positions the in-house startup program accurately within the framework of technology strategy and technology acquisition approaches. → CLO1	30	Defines the program and distinguishes its types (e.g., internal call-for-proposals, CVC-linked, spin-off); states its purpose within technology strategy (new business exploration, technology acquisition, talent development); and explains, with literature, how it differs from and complements the other technology acquisition approaches (in-house R&D, alliances, industry–government–academia collaboration, external venture collaboration).	Defines the program and states its purpose within technology strategy, but the comparison with other technology acquisition approaches is partial, or the distinction between program types is unclear.	Describes the program only in general terms; the relationship to technology strategy and technology acquisition approaches is missing or incorrect.
LO2 Multi-perspective analysis Analyses the merits and demerits of the program from the perspective of corporate management, on the basis of evidence. → CLO2	40	Analyses both merits and demerits from at least three managerial perspectives (e.g., resource allocation, R&D organisation design, people and careers, IP and governance, finance and investment appraisal, business portfolio); every argument is supported by	Covers both merits and demerits, but from two or fewer perspectives, or some arguments lack supporting evidence; trade-offs are mentioned only weakly.	One-sided (merits or demerits only), unsupported by evidence, or limited to a list of general statements and opinions.

		literature or a concrete case; and trade-offs between perspectives (e.g., autonomy versus control) are addressed.		
LO3 Recommendations and academic writing Derives feasible recommendations from the analysis and presents them in an appropriate academic form. → CLO3	30	Recommendations follow logically from the analysis in LO2; the target company's conditions (size, industry, technology resources) are specified; concrete design and operating measures are proposed (e.g., evaluation criteria, resource allocation rules, interface with the parent organisation, exit criteria). The structure is clear, at least five sources are cited correctly in APA style, and the word-count requirement is met.	Recommendations are given but only partly connected to the analysis, or the measures are generic. Minor deficiencies in structure or citation (formatting errors, fewer sources than required).	No recommendations, or recommendations unrelated to the analysis. Unclear structure; citations inappropriate or missing; word count far outside the requirement.

3. Scoring

Formula: Total (out of 100) = $\Sigma (\text{weight} \times \text{level score} \div 3)$

Example: LO1 = 3, LO2 = 2, LO3 = 3 → $30 \times 3/3 + 40 \times 2/3 + 30 \times 3/3 = 30 + 26.7 + 30 = 86.7$

4. Principles for level judgement (shared by AI draft grading and instructor review)

- Every level descriptor is written so that **evidence can be quoted from the submission**. A grade must cite the passage that supports it.
- A level is awarded only when **all** conditions of that level are met. If any condition of a higher level is missing, award the level below (criterion-based, not deduction-based).
- The formal requirements in LO3 (number of sources, APA style, word count) are checked **independently** of the content assessment.
- The AI produces a **draft** grade with quoted evidence; the instructor examines the evidence, may revise any level, and releases the final grade.

Prepared for the guest lecture "Vibe coding is a new way of making things", UTM Centre for Engineering Education, 21 Sep 2026.
Lecturer names in the sample syllabus are anonymised; the rubric is a teaching sample.